

Open Squelch

Quarterly Publication of The Van Wert Amateur Radio Club

146.250 / .850 Repeater to have a new home.

by: Steve Kouts, WA8WKF, Radio Officer

Rick McCoy advised that the State of Ohio will be building a new tower east of Van Wert for the MARKS Communications System. Target date is July 1, 2009. When completed he will be moving the system to the new site. Antenna height and power will remain the same as the current operation. Our current site will no longer be available since they want \$600.00 per month for the use of the tower and facility. The new system will be for EMA and State use. The system is owned by the EMA and was purchased with a grant from Homeland Security.

22nd ANNUAL VAN WERT HAMFEST

Gates open to public

SUNDAY JULY 19th

CQ
CQ
De
W8FY

Tickets
\$5.00
Donation

Free
Parking
During
Hamfest

8:00 am (EDST)

Setup:
6:00 am (EDST)

Tables: 8 ft, Indoor-\$10.00
(Includes 1 free ticket per vendor)

Outside Truck Sales:
FREE with paid ticket

ADVANCE TABLE RESERVATIONS
OR TICKETS NOT REQUIRED.

CAMPING:
OVERNIGHT - \$13.00
REQUIRED BY FAIR BOARD

2009

VAN WERT COUNTY
FAIRGROUNDS
US RT 127 SOUTH

VISIT OUR WEBSITE

WWW.W8FY.ORG
146.250/.850 Rpt

VAN WERT
AMATEUR
RADIO CLUB

POB 602
VAN WERT, OH
45891-0602

Van Wert CAP is reorganizing

Van Wert's chapter of the Civil Air Patrol is in the process of reorganizing. It is not clear at this time whether or not the new leadership will include Ham Radio in its program.

In the recent past the local CAP members have studied and passed ham radio license exams. Presently there is a two-meter radio at their headquarters. W8FY plans to retrieve the radio but leave the antenna system in place in case of emergencies, or re-install it if the new leadership pursues ham radio communications. It is our understanding that the current CAP membership includes no ham radio operators.

Club radio to be repaired

At the March 21st meeting, W8FY members voted to repair the ICOM 746 radio, which is suffering from lack of power. The radio will be sent off to the shop to cure the ills and have any modifications and updates made as well.

FCC defines "repeater"

In December of 2007, Gary Mitchell, WB6YRU, President of the Northern California Packet Association (NCPA), filed a petition with the FCC, asking for the Commission to clarify the definition of a repeater. According to Part 97, Section 3(a)(39), a repeater in the Amateur service is "[a]n amateur station that simultaneously retransmits the transmission of another amateur station on a different channel or channels."

Mitchell sought clarification on the word "simultaneously," asking if it referred to the signal information being retransmitted, or to the fact that the receiver and transmitter must both be active at the same time while acting on the same signal information. On March 23, 2009, the Commission clarified that even if there is a slight delay between what is received and what it transmits (as in the case of D-STAR and other digital repeaters), it is considered simultaneous if the receiver and transmitter are both active at the same time.

Mitchell pointed out in his petition that while the Commission's Rules specify on which bands amateur repeaters may operate, "some amateur repeaters are operating on bands other than set forth in Section 97.205 (b) with systems that are essentially voice repeater stations, but that digitize and retransmit the user's voice, on the theory that because there is a small delay in retransmitting the signal of another amateur station, the signal is not "simultaneously" retransmitted and, therefore, the system is not a repeater." The commission did not agree, stating that the word 'simultaneously' as used in the definition of a repeater station, refers to the receiver and transmitter both being active at the same time, and the stations need to be licensed as repeaters.

Ohio ARES Conference

Ralph WB8YIH and Cork W8DHG attended the conference in Reynoldsburg at the Fire Academy on March 28. It was a good get together with about 100 or more from all over the state. The FREE Pizza lunch was good too, sorry you missed it, better luck next time.

Our almost new, less than a year in the position, ARRL Ohio Section EC Jack Sovik KB8WPZ, was moderator for the program. Joe Phillips K8QOE our Ohio Section Mgr. and Gary Johnson KI4LA the Vice-Director of the Great Lakes Division had some opening remarks, as usual Joe is a great cheerleader and got things started right.

Don, WB8SIQ Asst. Net Manager of the Ohio Single Sideband Net, spoke of the Nets operation and the need to have more use of the of the Net by ARES. OSSBN meets three times a day and could handle formal traffic across the state for the local nets.

The reports of the District EC's was informative although it showed the disparity between the population centers and the rural areas of the state. There is a lot more activity and equipment, (digital etc.) in the cities and the need is greater there, but we all have the need to feed information into the system in time of emergency. Ralph gave the report for the second District that Gary provided, good job Ralph. We found out later that we have an ADEC (Area Digital E C) appointed and he is Eric, N1ICS near Middle Point. I hope Eric can help get us up to speed on the needs here in Van Wert County.

An APRS demo was provided by Matt Welch KBILCS, a good presentation and lots of enthusiasm, it should be on the web and perhaps we can get it for local viewing at the Club. The word is there is a lot more to APRS than trace lines on the screen. Perhaps we should be making more use of the system. Watching KA8ZGE move around the country is fun, but there seems to be a lot more to the system.

Digital Communications-Where are we headed? Was the last session and it was presented by John Tipka, W8UL Ohio Section Traffic Manager. I think there is a Power Point on the web that he used and perhaps we should get it and take a look because I know I won't get all the points, let alone the comments. The key word is still Interoperability and also duplication to achieve dependability. The ultimate desire is still WinLink 2000 and the use of AirMail which is part of that program. Having said that he seemed to continue with what sounded like reality setting in. Certainly error correction is the first need and Pactor 1,2, and 3 seem to him to be the best answer. However a Pactor 3 unit is around \$1400 or more and it may be fine if someone or agency provides it but the reality is not many will or can reach in our pocket and buy one. There is a software version in Beta testing and if it works it would sure cut costs. Also he says the use of AirMail on packet or other ax.25 type correcting protocols could be incorporated and provide the interoperability that is needed. RTTY and PSK 31 will not do the job, no error correction.

My final confusion from the conference, Legacy , the word legacy as used by a couple of speakers seemed to mean something from the past. As a computer program or operating system from the past that might do the job of some of the cutting edge stuff. It just seems to be an adjective not a noun and perhaps not a gift just the use of a legacy. I thought all that old stuff was junk, or junkie, or an antique, or perhaps vintage programs or equipment. O well, it's a legacy and perhaps ready to work as it always did. 73 Cork

The Van Wert Amateur Radio Club

2009 Spring Banquet

6:00 PM Saturday, April 18

Van Wert County EMA

Menu:

Swiss Steak and B.B.Q. Pork.

**Green Bean Casserole, California Blend, Baked Potatoes with butter and sour cream.
Tossed Salad with assorted dressing, Assorted Desserts some, sugar free, and fresh fruit.
Coffee and Ice Tea and Assorted bread and rolls with butter.**

The food will be served by Grants Catering.

Program:

The speaker will be Richard Eppstein, President of the Better Business Bureau.

He will talk about the latest current schemes and explains the most common ways people are cheated. He will also discuss the steps that all of us can take to protect ourselves, especially from identity theft.

The cost for the evening is \$10.00 per person

Reservations can be made with

Michele Thomas, KB8YXO

by phone at 419-399-3155

by e-mail at michele_thomas20032000@yahoo.com

or Cork and Joyce Poling at 419-749-2668.

We would like your reservation by April 6 2009

NEWS & Notes

Got a note from Ron, KA8NSG last week. He had a bad scare and emergency procedure by the time he wound up in the third hospital. They got him repaired & going. Heard him on the MI BR net, things are better. Hope things continue to be OK and also hope he finds a better signal into VW County.

Thanks to Steve WA8WKF for getting the Icom 746 off to the repair point. It got sent to WA, it seems he never did get a response from the repair place in MI after couple days of trying. To bad, other people have had good luck there. Perhaps there is just too much business at this time, The 746's are having lots of troubles at this time.

Have you paid yours dues yet, it is easy to forget. Get 'em paid or better yet get to a meeting and pay up there! While you are at it you may want to consider joining the ARRL, it's our only national organization for Amateur Radio and as you can see on the political scene we need to be represented and work for our place in the radio spectrum!

I know Mike is going to be talking about the Log Book of the World at the club meeting. However it's not all electronic out there, the report from the QSL Bureau from 2003-154,054; 2004-138,236; 2005- 110,905; 2006-111,734; 2007-89,028; 2008- 80,248. I guess the electronics may be cutting in or perhaps it's the lack of Sun Spots.

I know the Hamvention is right around the corner, and I hear people making plans and buying tickets. That is great, see you there but do you realize

we will be having a Great Lakes Division Convention the day before the Findlay Hamfest. September 12th is the day and it sure sounds like they will be putting on a big show. See you there also, what a deal.

It don't seem possible but the Peony Festival Parade will be June 6, right around the corner, and we need and appreciate the help of Hams from Delphos, Lima, Celina, wherever to help us put 20 plus rigs on the street. Invite them over, we will have some food after and a regular meeting also!

N8IHP had or has some tip-over towers, I know it's getting kind of warm for antenna WX but they might work.

Needles to say and as you can see I get confused easy. Some web sites, several actually, mess me up. So it was nice to hear Joe Phillips say it is easy to put the stuff on the web, it's just about impossible to get it off. For Ohio stuff of all kinds it seems www.arrloho.org might work OK. Perhaps you won't find so much stuff from years past.

April 1 first has come and gone so Larsen E Rapps signal sucker antenna that drew away all the QRM and ran it to ground don't count. However it does seem at times I can shut down a repeater and maybe a net by listing traffic. I know we don't get much TFC down the west side of the state, but please help when you can, thanks to all who have.

We hear complaints about Contests and Contesters, but there are always WARC bands and room. I worry more about the Dead Air the rest of the time. Have Fun. 73, Cork

W8FY member seeks equipment

Hey, Enclosed is a list of items that I am sort of looking for in the next 2 yrs. Whether it be purchased reasonably cheap and thru payments or donated or barter or trade or borrowed! All items must be working order. Best reasonable costs and payment terms are a must. I am hoping that you all may know of someone, or something who may have such or know of such. This list is subject to change.... Could be added too and could have things deleted as time goes. It's just a guide list ok. I am trying to use all available outlets and resources. Any and all help is appreciated. Will update the list periodically as items are located and such also. There is no rush items. Except for the HD power supply. Please email and info and such when you are aware of such ok.

Thanks and 73s, Ron KA8NSG.

Here is the List: (KA8NSG's wish and want list of 2009-2010)

1. 20-30 amp.meters, 13.8 VDC HD Power Supply
2. 2 Meter HT/ accessories
3. 5/8 wave, mag mt 2m mobile antenna
4. Good used Communications Receiver(15kc-30mc, all model
5. SB Series, Heathkit, External VFO
6. SB Series, Heathkit, Station Monitor, Phone Patch,Clock
7. SB 200 Heathkit RF Amplifier
8. ?? SB Series, Hthkt, 6 meter converter???
9. 0-150 VAC 3 inch, panel mt meter
10. 0- 30 Amps(AC) 3 inch panel my meter
11. portable field strength meter
12. 10 meter, CW/SSB mobile transceiver
13. TNC/modem/program for HF and VHF to computer for CW/RTTY/Amtor, ect
portable cassette recorder
14. 2 meter RF AMP, .5 to 5 watts in, 20-35 watts out, 12VDC 10W in/160W out 2 meter
RF Amp. 12 VDC Headset, with boom mic to use with the SB102
15. 6 position antenna switch
16. 2 position transceiver switch
17. 4 inch, silent cooling fan, 110VAC
18. Foot PTT Switch good WX Alert receiver
19. HF receiver preamp/preselector
20. Best reasonable priced Match Pair of 6146 B tubes for spares!!!!
21. mini workbench vice adjustable workbench lamp/magnifying glass combo with vice
clamp for wb edge.
22. good used MFJ ground tuner/artificial ground unit good cheap, simple code practice unit
or schematic and material list that uses a 9 volt battery(this is for my son, John to play
with and maybe learn CW yet!) My goal= to get him licensed by 10 yrs old)

2009	VWARC CALENDAR	2 Mtr Net
Apr 4 also 4th	VWARC Meeting at EMA Office, 8:00 PM. / Hamfest Meeting at 7:30 everyone is welcome! Missouri QSO Apr 11 Georgia QSO Party; JA Int'l DX CW; Hamfest, Lowell, MI	Apr 4 KH6ILT
Apr 18-19	Michigan & Ontario QSO and Run For the Bacon QRP: Milford, MI; Cuyahoga, Falls, OH	Apr 11 W8DHG
Apr 18 6:00 PM	VWARC SPRING BANQUET Good Food and a Special Night Out for Everyone at EMA & VWARC meeting room, catered by Linda Grant &	Apr 18 WD8MLV
PLEASE Contact Michele, KB8YXO, 419-399-3089 or Joyce, WD8LQC or Cork, W8DHG, 419-749-2668 or 146.85 repeater Let them know you are coming before APRIL 13th. You can pay reservations at the door. Just \$10.00 per person!		
Apr 25-26	FL, & NE QSO Parties, QRP to the Field; Hamfest, Athens, OH 26th	Apr 25 WB8YIH
May 2 May 2-3	VWARC Meeting at EMA Office, 8:00 PM. / Hamfest Meeting at 7:30 everyone is welcome! 7th Call Area, IN & New England QSO Prys; Hamfest, Cadillac, MI 5/6	May 2 KH6ILT
May 9-10	CQ Int. DX test CW; FISTS Spring Sprint	
May 15-17 May 16	Dayton Hamvention, and ARRL National Convention & EXPO VWARC Meeting at EMA Office, 8:00 PM. / Field Day Meeting at 7:30 **4F at EMA again**	May 9 W8DHG
May 16-17 May 30-31	His Majesity King of Spain Contest, CW; EU PSK DX Contest CQ WW WPX CW, May 24-25 MI QRP Club Memorial Day Sprint	May 16 WD8MLV
Jun 6 Sat	2:00 at PD on Street at 3! Peony Festival Parade we need 20 Hams on 2m, Bthere!	May 23 WB8YIH
Jun 6 Jun 13-14	VWARC Meeting at EMA Office, 8:00 PM. / everyone is welcome! Fulton Cty Fest Wauseo ARRL June VHF QSO Party	May 30 KH6ILT
Jun 20 also	** Kids Day ** Bring a Kid to Ham Radio, you can find one somewhere! WV & QC QSO Prys Hamfest Milford, OH; Midland, MI 20th Monroe, MI 21st	June 6 W8DHG
Jun 20	VWARC Meeting at EMA Office, 8:00 PM. / Field Day Meeting at 7:30 *just a week away*	
	👉👈👉👈👉👈👉👈	June 13 WD8MLV
☀️👉👈👉👈	up-set day-field 26 June; all hands can help! Friday afternoon after 2:00	
Jun 27-28	Field Day VWARC will be at the EMA & Marsh Foundation, and 4-F is GOOD!	June 20 WB8YIH
Jun 27	EXAMS Van Wert EMA 2 PM Contact Steve WA8WKF (pre-register) skouts@bright.net	
😊😊⇒	<i>and then the next weekend there is more to do!</i>	June 27 KH6ILT
July 4th July 4th July 4th	<i>Holiday at Home; Bicycle Tour in County, Museum and Special Event Station!</i> <i>It's an all day thing, bring an extra battery, have fun!</i>	July 4 W8DHG
	YES we need HELP for everything above and below!	
July 18 July 19 19 July	VWARC Meeting at Fair Ground IT'S SETUP TIME! 5:30 PM is good VWARC HAMFEST! Tell everyone, on the air and wherever you may be to be there, they will thank you for it, we all will! HAMFEST 2009 bethere!!!	July 11 WD8MLV
Aug 6	US127/US30 Garage Sale Crossover Point & Tractor Tour We need help! also Special Event Station W8FY at Club Station	July 18 WB8YIH

Thank you, to you 3 and to who ever else assisted in getting my good old Heathkit SB 102 back on the air and in operating condition! I really appreciated that. I am very grateful. 8 long years with out HF really was a bummer. I hope to stay more active now on HF and also on 2m. Its slow coming but I am working on it. Been very patient in 8 yrs. But it was worth it. Even sent the guy in NC where I got the parts from a good thank you letter and a update letter. Even though I am 50 miles away and I do attend as many meetings that I can. I still miss being more active in the club. Somehow things always will work out. The club and you all mean a lot to me. You all are a swell bunch! Always enjoy seeing you all and of course all the fun of being a member of this fine club. Again, thank you, Cork, Mike, Tom and who all helped. And thank you W8FY for being the best club that I belong too. Again, thank you.

73s, Ron, KA8NSG

22nd ANNUAL

VAN WERT HAMFEST-SUNDAY, JULY 19TH, 2009

VAN WERT COUNTY FAIRGROUNDS, US RT. 127 SOUTH

Gates open to the public at 8:00 am EDST, 6:00 am EDST for setup. Tables; 8 ft. Indoor, \$10.00 (Includes one free ticket per vendor)

Advance table reservations or tickets not required. Tickets \$5.00 donation, FREE Parking during Hamfest

Overnight Camping \$13.00 required by Fairboard

Tentatively scheduled: Phil's Ham Radio Store

Visit our website: www.w8fy.org

**Van Wert Amateur Radio Club
PO Box 602
Van Wert, Ohio 45891**